WP-4B-02: Enoxaparin for prevention of venous thromboembolism

Example General Hospital, Ward 4B. Version 3 (fictional). Owner: Ward 4B nurse in charge (fictional role).

FICTIONAL TRAINING DOCUMENT. Not clinical guidance. Example General Hospital is fictional.

Scope

Adult inpatients on Ward 4B prescribed enoxaparin to prevent venous thromboembolism. Treatment doses are outside this protocol.

Usual dose

40 mg by subcutaneous injection once daily.

Creatinine clearance below 30 mL/min: 20 mg once daily. Check the most recent renal result before every dose.

Ward 4B local rules

- Give the daily dose at 18:00 unless the prescriber records another time.
- Weight below 50 kg or above 150 kg: ask the ward pharmacist to confirm the dose before the first injection.
- Platelet count below 100 x 10^9/L, or a fall of more than half from baseline: hold the dose and contact the prescriber.

Administration

Inject deep subcutaneously into the abdomen, at least 5 cm from the umbilicus, alternating left and right sides. Do not expel the air bubble from a pre-filled syringe and do not rub the site after injection.

When to hold and escalate

Active bleeding, a new bleeding risk such as a planned procedure, or an epidural or spinal catheter in place or planned: hold the dose and contact the prescriber, who coordinates timing with the anaesthetic team.